

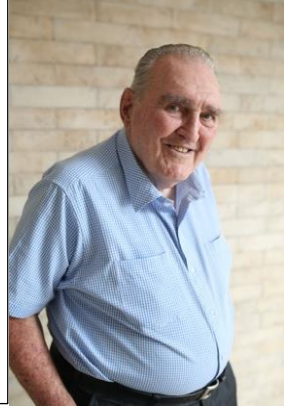


The Garamut “The message sender”

Ps Barry Reflections from ‘The WORD’!

**For PRAYER,
PROCLAMATION &
PERSONAL PROGRESS**

Bethel Global Missions
No. 27. For 3rd of August 2026.



Theme: “DON’T GO TOO FAR”.

IT’S OK TO WORSHIP THE LORD – BUT DON’T GO TOO FAR.

This was Pharaoh of Egypt reluctantly permitting the children of Israel’s desire to travel three days and worship Jehovah God.

YOU SHALL NOT GO VERY FAR AWAY.

Exodus 8:28 And Pharaoh said, I will let you go, that ye may sacrifice to the Lord your God in the wilderness; *only ye shall not go very far away: intreat for me.* KJV

‘BUT DON’T GO TOO FAR’ COULD BE INTERPRETED IN TWO WAYS – GEOGRAPHICALLY relating to DISTANCE; OR IT COULD MEAN; **DON’T BE TOO PASSIONATE ABOUT WORSHIPING GOD – DON’T OVER DO IT.**

Exodus 8:28 "All right, go ahead," Pharaoh replied, "but *don’t go too far away.* Now, hurry and *plead with God for me.*" TLB

Exodus 8:28 "All right, go ahead," Pharaoh replied. "I will let you go into the wilderness to offer sacrifices to the Lord your God. *But don’t go too far away. Now hurry and pray for me.*" NLT

Exodus 8:28 The king said, "I will let you go so that you may offer sacrifices to the Lord your God in the desert, *but you must not go very far away. Now go and pray for me.*" NCV

AND PHAROAH HAD THE AUDACITY (DARING) **TO ASK ISRAEL PRAY TO YOUR GOD FOR HIM.**

SUBTLY AND CUNNINGLY SUGGESTING THAT SOMEHOW, HE WAS ON THEIR SIDE AND SUPPORTING THEM.

PHAROAH IS LIKE THE PRINCE OF THIS WORLD – THE DEVIL ENDEAVOURING TO DO THE SAME THING TO GOD’S PEOPLE – LYING AND DECEIVING.

THE ENEMY’S STRATEGY IS TO **TELL EVERY BELIEVER THAT IT IS OK TO STEP OUT TO DO SOMETHING FOR GOD – BUT DON’T ALLOW YOUR FAITH TO TAKE YOU TOO FAR** – DO EVERYTHING IN MODERATION BUT DON’T BE TOO ADVENTUROUS OR RISK TAKING FOR GOD’S KINGDOM BUSYNESS.

PERSONALLY

I AM REMINDED OF HOW I LIVED BEFORE COMING TO CHRIST “CLOSE TO THE EDGE,” RECKLESSLY, WITHOUT RESTRAINT AND LAWLESS. I PRESENTED THE IMAGE AS BEING RESPECTABLE AND NOT TOO BAD A PERSON – BUT IN REALITY, NOT REALLY GOOD.

THE PERMISSABLE & THE ACCEPTABLE

AFTER FINDING CHRIST AS LORD, I THEN HAD THE BATTLE WITH HOW NOT TO LIVE WITH JUST WHAT WAS PERMISSABLE – BUT WHAT WAS ACCEPTABLE TO GOD AND HOW I MIGHT LIVE CLOSER TO GOD AND HIS WAYS.

JUST LIKE EGYPT’S PHAROAH, THE DEVIL THE ENEMY OF GOD’S REDEEMED PEOPLE **DOESN’T WANT THEM TO GO TOO FAR AWAY** FROM HIS INFLUENCE OR CONTROL. IN REALITY HE IS SAYING IT IS OK TO GO A LITTLE DISTANCE **BUT NOT VERY FAR.** THAT’S THE DEVIL’S **“BORDERLINE LIVING”.**

BORDERLINE LIVING

- **“Borderline”** is something positioned on the edge – or almost meeting a standard but not fully; or something lacking clarity between two different categories.
- **BORDERLINE LIVING** IS LIKE HAVING ONE LEG OR FOOT IN GOD’S KINGDOM AND THE OTHER IN THIS WORLD’S SYSTEMS.
- **BORDERLINE LIVING** IS LIKE LIVING AS CLOSE TO THE EDGE WITHOUT FALLING OVER THE EDGE.

PERMISSABILITY & ACCEPTABILITY

IT IS LIVING LIFE CLOSE TO THE EXTREMITIES / BOUNDARIES OF WHAT MIGHT BE PERMISSIBLE OR ACCEPTABLE TO GOD BUT NOT NECESSARILY HIS PREFERRED / PERFECT WAY OF LIVING - **WHICH IS TO BE CLOSE TO HIM.**

- **BORDERLINE LIVING** MEANS NOT TO BEING FULLY COMMITTED TO LIVING GOD'S WAY (IT'S NOMINAL CHRISTIANITY) – (having a form of godliness – but denying it's power).
- **BORDERLINE LIVING** IS LIVING RECKLESSLY – CARELESSLY FOOLISHLY – WITHOUT GODLY RESTRAINT.
- **THE DEVIL SAYS** IT IS ALRIGHT TO GO A LITTLE DISTANCE FROM GOD'S WAY AND PURPOSES - BUT NOT TOO FAR AWAY.
THIS PRESENT WORLD CALLS FOR HALF HEARTEDNESS – NOT TOTAL COMMITMENT.
- **PHAROAH WAS HAPPY** FOR GOD'S PEOPLE TO GO A LITTLE WAY TO WORSHIP GOD **BUT NOT VERY FAR AWAY**.
- THE IMPLICATION IS THAT HE STILL WANTED THEM CLOSE SO THAT HE COULD CONTINUE TO INFLUENCE THE ATTITUDES AND DIRECTION OF THEIR LIVES.

HOW TRUE THIS IS TODAY

- THAT THE ENEMY IS 'OK' FOR YOU AND I WORSHIPING THE LORD BUT DON'T GO TOO FAR WITH THAT.
- DON'T OVERDO IT, DON'T BE TOO PASSIONATE ABOUT IT, JUST GO.
- THROUGH THE MOTIONS, SING THE SONGS, PARTICIPATE, BUT DON'T GET TOO AFFECTED BY IT ALL.

SERVICE AS WORSHIP

THE ENEMY DOESN'T WANT US TO BE THE KIND OF PEOPLE WHO EXPRESSES THEIR WORSHIP TO GOD THROUGH THEIR FAITHFUL DAILY SERVICE THAT HAVE BEEN ENTRUSTED TO THEM.

JOSHUA & CALEB - WHOLE HEARTEDLY FOLLOWED.

- Which meant they were close to - not afar off from God.
- God wants people who are following close after him.
Numbers 32:12 The only exceptions are Caleb son of Jephunneh the Kenizzite and Joshua son of Nun, for they have wholeheartedly followed the Lord.' NLT

KING AMAZIAH (Jerusalem) DID WHAT WAS RIGHT BUT RESENTED IT.

- HE DID WHAT WAS RIGHT IN GOD'S SIGHT BUT SOMETIMES **RESENTED IT** - 2 Chronicles 25:2
He did what was right but sometimes resented it! TLB
- HE DID IT **RELUCTANTLY** – BUT NOT **WHOLEHEARTEDLY**.
2 Chronicles 25:2 He did what was pleasing to the Lord but did it reluctantly. GNT - 2 Chronicles 25:2 He did what was right in the eyes of the Lord, but not wholeheartedly. NIV
- NOT WITH A **PERFECT** OR **BLAMELESS HEART** – NOT WITH A **LOYAL HEART** - 2 Chronicles 25:2 He did right in the Lord's sight, but not with a **perfect or blameless heart**. AMP - 2 Chronicles 25:2 And he did what was right in the sight of the Lord, but not with a loyal heart. NKJV
- HE DID NOT **REALLY WANT TO OBEY**
*2 Chronicles 25:2 Amaziah did what the Lord said was right, but he did not **really want to obey him**. NCV*

PETER FOLLOWED AFAR OFF

*Luke 22:54 Then took they him, and led him, and brought him into the high priest's house. **And Peter followed afar off** - Mark 14:54 Matthew 26:58. KJV*

HALLELUJAH! OUR GOD IS NOT A GOD AFAR OFF

*Jeremiah 23:23 Am I a God at hand, saith the Lord, and not a God afar off? KJV
Jeremiah 23:23 "Am I only a God the Lord, "and not a God far away? NIV*

GOD KEEPS HIS DISTANCE FROM THE PROUD

Psalms 138:6 Yet though he is so great, he respects the humble, but proud men must keep their distance. TLB

LET US BE A PEOPLE WHO LIVE OUR LIVES CLOSE TO GOD REFLECTING HIS GOODNESS, RIGHTNESS, AND PURITY AND ALWAYS DISTANCING OURSELVES FROM THE DEVIL'S INFLUENCE AND CONSTANT MARKETING OF FALSHOODS.

Amen Ps Barry